



Festival of Writing

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March 1 - 30, 2024

The Polk County History Center invites you to experience the second Annual Festival of Writing. Opening during the 53rd Annual Bloomin' Arts Festival, this monthlong exhibition features the work of Creative Writing and Graphic Design students from Southeastern University in Polk County. This unique partnership showcases the students' abilities to interpret Polk County's history in an artistic medium, and it fosters important collaborative skills, which are essential to future success.

The inaugural Festival of Writing was held in 2023, and it featured 19 student authors guided by Associate Professor of Creative Writing Amanda Forrester, as well as 23 design students directed by Associate Professor of Graphic Design SaiEd Farisi.

The Festival of Writing at the Polk County History Center opens on Friday, March 1. The artistic works will be on display until Saturday, March 30. The exhibition will then move to Southeastern University.

The Polk County History Center is open Tuesday to Saturday, 9 a.m to 5 p.m and admission is always free. For more information, visit www.polkhistorycenter.org or call (863) 534-4386.

Poet: Raeliah Cumbie
Designer: Lorenzo Wolley
Southeastern University



The Singing Tower **Golden**

*rays and silver mist
twist into a crown.
Painted glass and rosy bricks
rise up from the ground.*

*Azaleas and irises
waltz
under her gaze.
Ripples in the lake
of glass replicate her face.*

*If you pay attention,
you will feel the drum
of her copper
heartbeat,
to which the land succumbs.*

*Her song is laced with secrets
from stories she's been told.
One hundred years
of **whispers**
and wonders
she beholds.*